

Brand assets – colour

The basic concepts and approaches that govern correct colour use

February 2024 | V3

Your story matters



Contents

1	A new positioning for Absa	2	5	Colour in action	27
2	The story of our colours	3		Imagery	28
3	Colour palette	4		Layouts	30
	The stories behind our colour names	5		Gesture patterns	34
	Specifications	6		Gestures patterns – apparel	35
	Application ratios	7		Gestures patterns – promotional items	36
4	Application	8		Gestures patterns – marketing collateral	38
	Black for body copy in print	9		Illustrations	39
	This is what red feels like	10		Iconography	45
	This is what red feels like – gradients	14	6	Bespoke patterns	47
	Bicolour gradients	15		The colour checklist	50
	Tricolour gradients	17	7	Contact information	51
	Application categories	23			
	Contrast variations	24			

A new positioning for Absa

Throughout our brand journey, Absa has focused on creating a brand that is authentically African. A bank for the people, with its roots and an outlook that is firmly of this soil. We took inspiration from the people and the landscapes – the things that are inherent parts of our identity.

As we embark on a new chapter in the Absa story, we're embracing a narrative that is focused on people and their stories. By placing ourselves as a supporting character in their lives, we aim to play a meaningful role in their potential to live a better life. To them, we say, "Your story matters". And this is our new positioning.

We want to put our customers and clients first in everything we do – it's their story and we are there to support them empathetically, by offering financial solutions that will help them achieve their goals.

The new positioning also affects how we show up as a brand from a visual identity perspective. We have condensed our visual identity, to mark the change and make it more simplified and distinctive.

Please take careful consideration of the following guidelines as there have been important changes from previous versions.

The story of our colours

As a brand born of Africa, we embrace the profound essence of red. It signifies our deep-rooted connection with Africa. Just as red courses through the veins of this vibrant continent, it pulses through its people, symbolising passion, courage and the unyielding spirit that defines us. And it's this passion that inspired our colour palette.

Spearheaded by Passion red, a colour that's the very embodiment of the African spirit, to a range of secondary red hues and accent colours that help bring this fiery essence to life. It's these vibrant colours that inspired our purpose to passionately empower Africa and give back to its people.

By using this colour palette every day, we live out our values and put our purpose into action. And it's through our use of this vibrant colour that we reflect on our past, nod our heads to today and paint a picture of tomorrow.



Colour palette

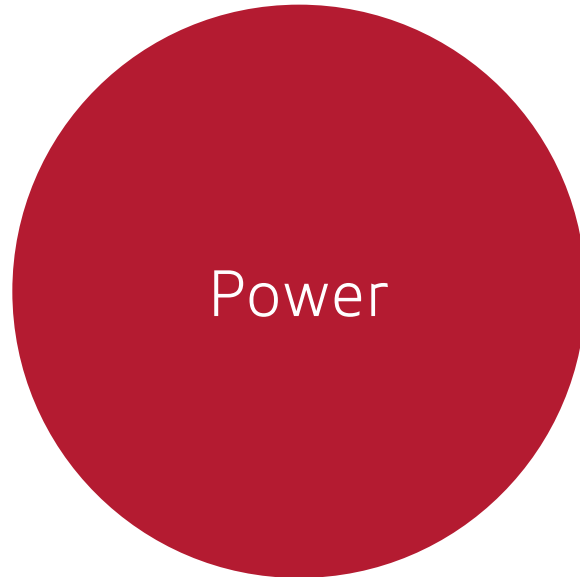
The stories behind our colour names

Africa stirs something deep within the soul. It's a land of passion and feeling. A land that moves you. To capture this essence, we delved deep into colour psychology and hand-picked names inspired by what these colours mean. To reflect our broader narrative, each colour builds on our African story and is underpinned by our strategic ambition, Purpose, Values or Brand Essence.



Passion

We're **passionate** about Africa and its people. We turn our passion into purpose as we strive to empower them to write their stories of turbulence and triumph as we co-create a better tomorrow.



Power

The **power** of the African continent lies in its people. In their hopes and dreams and aspirations. We recognise this drive, and we support it, so that the Africa of tomorrow will be seen as a leader on the world stage.



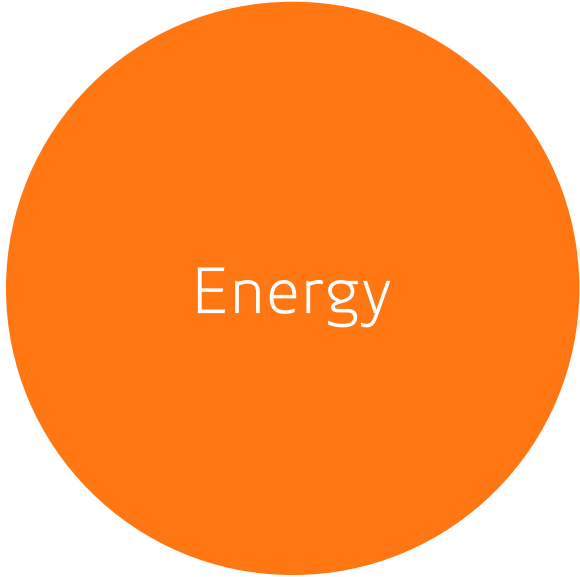
Hope

Hope is the ember that keeps the fire alive in the soul of the African nation. And it's the heartbeat that drives us to be better, do more and commit to creating a brighter future for us all.



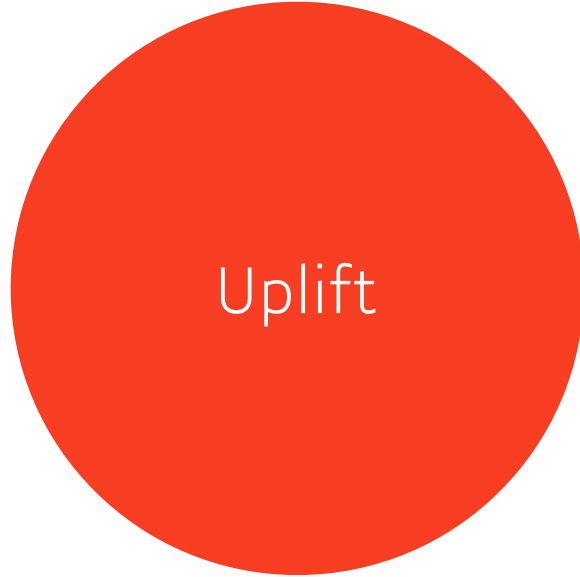
Inspire

Africa is our muse, our source of **inspiration**. From scarlet sunsets to the roaming hills and it's resilient people, it's what drives us to build, progress and empower Africans to use their wealth to change the world.



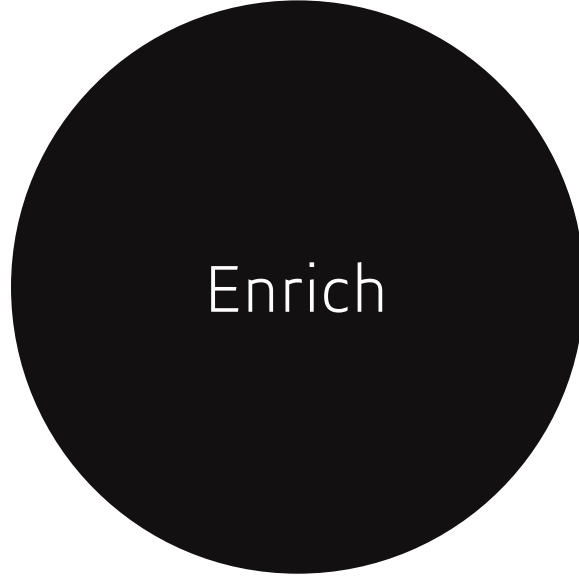
Energy

Energy is that endless source of perseverance that drives you to carry on. It's that will to outperform that's innate to Africa. And it's this tenacity that we fuel so that all Africans can have the tomorrow they deserve.



Uplift

Africa and its people are what push us to achieve more every day. And by being a force for good in our communities, we help inspire, guide and encourage others so that they too can **uplift** themselves to new heights.



Enrich

As a bank rooted in Africa, we're fortunate to have been **enriched** by its diverse people. We're a tapestry of their pasts and presents, their aspirations, drive and energy. We appreciate them and endeavour to support them.



Serene

The unmatched beauty of Africa evokes a sense of tranquility in all that gaze upon it. And it's this sense of **serenity** that we hope to instill in the people of this great land, through our ethos of being an active force for good.

Specifications

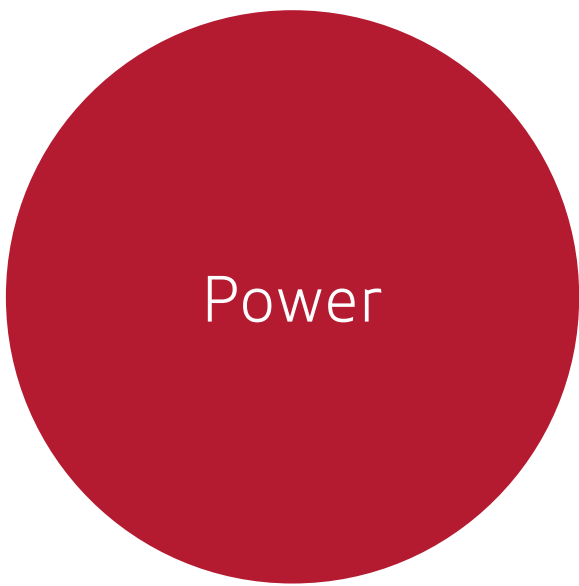
Here we've indicated the colour breakdowns for each of the colours in our rich palette, inspired by your stories.

Please note that due to varying monitor and printer settings, colour combinations should always be checked using accurate and dependable colour proofing systems before approving artwork for production.



Passion

220R 0G 55B
1C 99M 78Y 0K
#DC0037
Pantone® 199C



Power

181R 2G 50B
8C 97M 79Y 20K
#B50232
Pantone® 200C



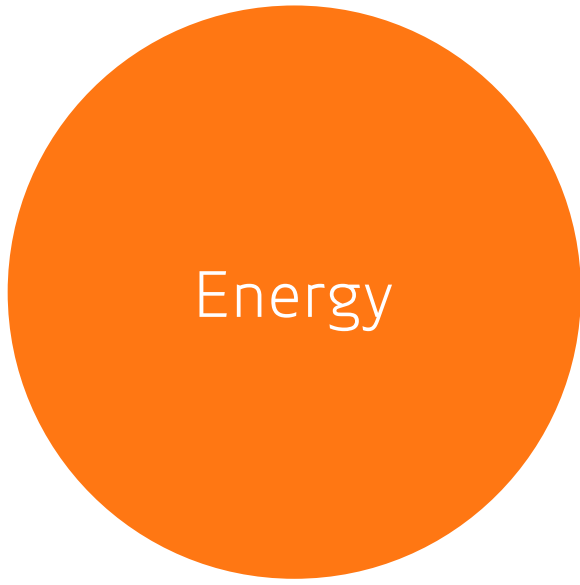
Hope

149R 5G 42B
16C 94M 80Y 27K
#95052A
Pantone® 201C



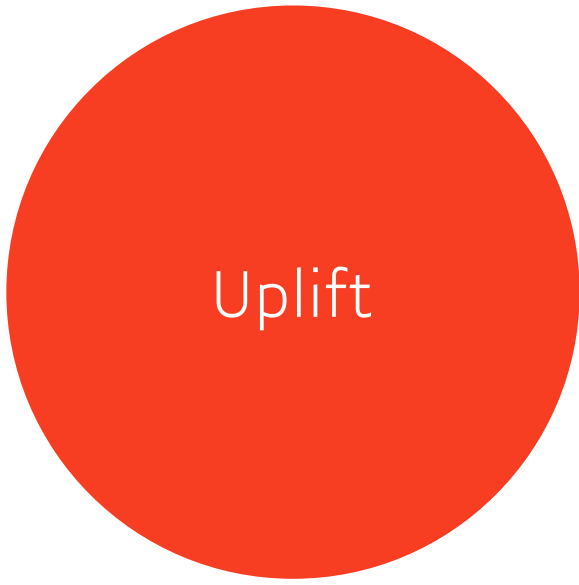
Inspire

119R 2G 30B
13C 95M 88Y 45K
#77021E
Pantone® 202C



Energy

255R 120G 15B
0C 65M 100Y 0K
#FF780F
Pantone® 1585C



Uplift

249R 63G 36B
0C 80M 80Y 0K
#F93F24
Pantone® Warm Red C



Enrich

19R 16G 16B
40C 70M 70Y 100K
#131010
Pantone® 6C



Serene

255R 255G 255B
0C 0M 0Y 0K
#FFFFFF

Application ratios



Application

Black for body copy in print

When litho printing text, especially small and fine body copy, use OC OM OY 100K to ensure that it's crisp and legible.

Please note that due to varying monitor and printer settings, colour combinations should always be checked using accurate and dependable colour proofing systems before approving artwork for production.



This is what red feels like

For Absa to show up as a consistently red brand, it requires a balanced combination of our fundamental brand assets: our logo lockup (logo badge and positioning line) and primary colour, Passion.

Passion background



Brand assets – colour



Logo badge

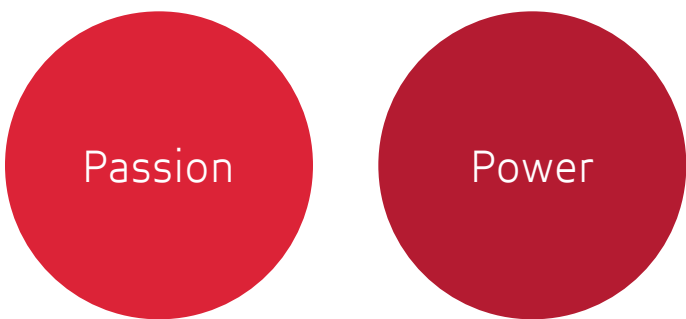


Logo lockup

This is what red feels like

For Absa to show up as a consistently red brand, it requires a balanced combination of our fundamental brand assets: our logo lockup (logo badge and positioning line) and primary colour, Passion.

Passion badge
Power background



Logo badge



Logo lockup

This is what red feels like

We show up using the right amount of red and we never shy away from it.

This is showing up perfectly red

This is showing up red

and this is not red enough.

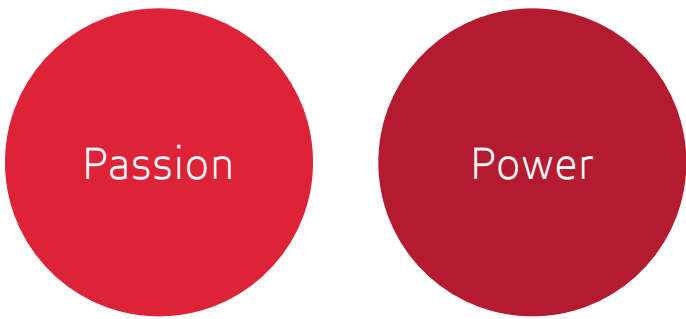
This is showing up perfectly red

This is showing up red

and this is not red enough.

This is what red feels like

Here you can see how red shows up in a perfectly balanced way. Using our primary colour with secondary colours to create a predominant feel of red, with a hint of accent colours, a mix of low and high contrast and gestures.

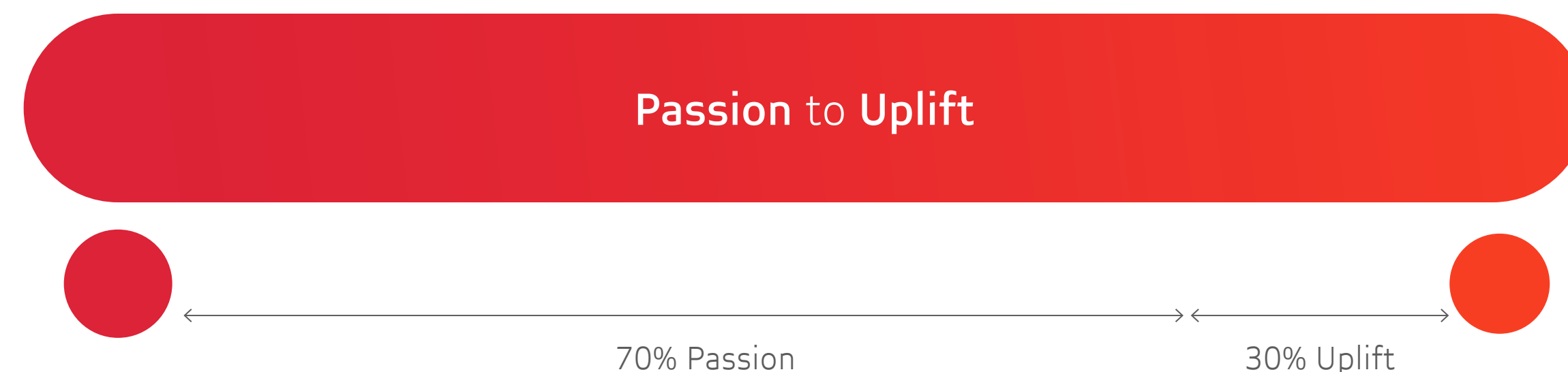


This is what red feels like – gradients

Using gradients that feature Passion red blending into a secondary colour can be achieved while still maintaining a predominantly red look. Gradients always start from bottom left to top right (at a 45 degree angle) and always start with Passion. The gradient should be 70% Passion leading to 30% of the second colour.

Gradients may only be used for social media, digital banners, powerpoint presentations and emailers. Gradients can also be used for QTV screens with iconography and occasionally for videos.

The only time gradients can be used for print material is for divider pages (using the gestures patterns), guidebooks and pitch books.



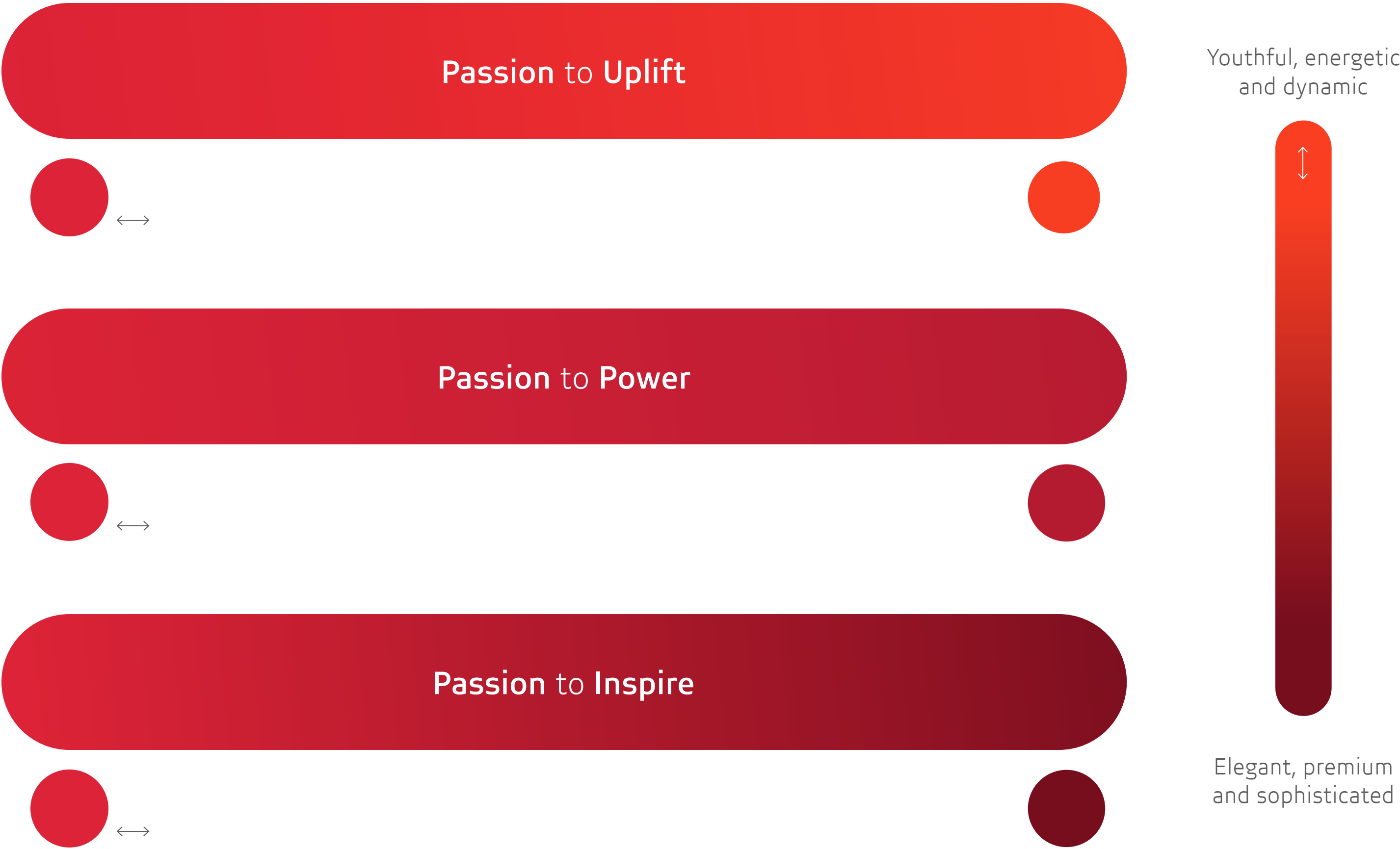
Gradients can
activate layouts

and add dynamism.

Bicolour gradients

Gradients introduce dynamism and energy to enhance layouts, offering a creative path to breathe life into the Absa brand. Incorporating gradients into layouts give them vibrancy and energy that can be used to target different audiences as shown.

There are bi- and tricolour gradients to choose from that will ensure that applications and layouts portray a predominantly red and warm brand. Passion must always be part of the gradient. Gradients are made up of no more than three approved colours that are close/next to each other on the spectrum. These gradients are adaptable in layouts and can be constructed as shown here.



This is what red feels like

Gradients that infuse Passion with Energy feel more youthful and dynamic, while gradients that incorporate Enrich tend towards a more sophisticated style.

Gradients may only be used on social media, emailers and digital items. The only exception for print material would be for usage on covers or smaller leaflets/flyers.



They can be playful
and energetic

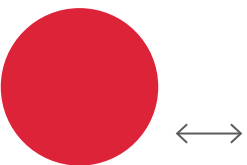
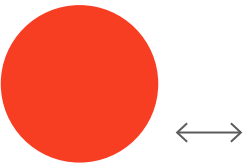
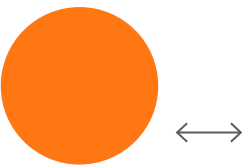


or sophisticated
and elegant.

Tricolour gradients

Gradients introduce dynamism and energy to enhance layouts, offering a creative path to breathe life into the Absa brand. Incorporating gradients into layouts give them vibrancy and energy that can be used to target different audiences as shown.

There are bi- and tricolour gradients to choose from that will ensure that applications and layouts portray a predominantly red and warm brand. Passion must always be part of the gradient. Gradients are made up of no more than three approved colours that are close/next to each other on the spectrum. These gradients are adaptable in layouts and can be constructed as shown here.



Youthful, energetic
and dynamic



Elegant, premium
and sophisticated

This is what red feels like

Using low-contrast colours creates a soft blend that’s easy on the eye and feels more appealing.
It should not be used for communicating critical information. Low contrast creates a feeling of elegance.



This is what red feels like

High-contrast colours draw attention where needed and convey information effectively.



**High contrast
creates a
striking layout**



This is what red feels like

Our full colour palette can create depth and variation in illustrations to paint a more engaging world. This is an example of how the full colour palette can show up using our ratio principles. Illustrations may be used for emailers, storyboards, QTVs, ATMs, animation videos and explainers.



This is what red feels like

The strategic but sparing use of accent colours can breathe life into our colour palette, giving us a visual destination.



This is what red feels like

Through our colour palette and range of skin tones we can tell stories of empowerment that keeps us moving forward. How we mix them, is where the magic lies.

Advancing diversity through colour



Application categories

Passion is always our primary colour, however, in different applications our full colour palette may be incorporated. The categories below indicate how our colour palette can be applied to create impact while remaining true to our brand.

		Primary	Secondary				Accent			White	Greens, blues and skin tones										Neutrals					
		Passion	Power	Hope	Inspire	Energy	Uplift	Enrich	Serene	Grass	Moss	Sky	Navy	Natural 1	Natural 2	Natural 3	Natural 4	Natural 5	Natural 6	Natural 7	Grey 6	Grey 5	Grey 4	Grey 3	Grey 2	Grey 1
Core	Signage	●	●						●																	
	Stationery	●							●																	
Presence	Branches	●	●	●	●	●		●	●																	
	ATM profiles	●	●	●					●																	
	Corporate buildings	●	●	●	●			●	●																	
	Presence branding	●							●																	
	Event branding	●	●	●	●			●	●																	
Marketing and comms	Internal	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●																	
	External	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●																	
Objects	Promotional items	●	●	●	●			●	●																	
	Merchandise	●	●	●	●			●	●																	
Graphics	Illustrations	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
	Bespoke patterns	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●																	
	Gesture patterns	●	●	●	●	●	●																			
Reporting	Reporting	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●											●	●	●	●	●	●
UI	Website	●	●	●	●			●	●	●	●	●	●								●	●	●	●	●	●
	Banking App	●	●	●	●			●	●	●	●	●	●								●	●	●	●	●	●
	Functional ATM screens	●	●	●	●			●	●												●	●	●	●	●	●
	Queueing system	●	●	●	●			●	●												●	●	●	●	●	●

Contrast variations

The following pages show the recommended high-, medium- and low-contrast colour variations for RGB (digital) applications, as the document is set in RGB.

RGB applications include examples such as emailers, digital banners, social media posts, videos, etc.

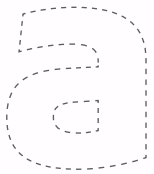
CMYK applications include examples such as posters, billboards, pamphlets, brochures, business cards, etc.

⊗ Please avoid using the same colour text as the background.

If a high impact is intended, such as an attention-grabbing billboard headline, high-contrast colours should be used. High-contrast colours are equally appropriate where high-yield is required, such as in the body copy of a report or when displaying key information.

Medium-contrast combinations can be used where a subtle or low-impact effect is intended. Examples of appropriate medium-contrast applications include Wealth product branding, wallpaper artwork and backgrounds. Low-contrast combinations can be used on tonal applications that are more aesthetic than informative.

Please note that due to varying monitor and printer settings, colour combinations should always be checked using accurate and dependable colour proofing systems before approving artwork for production.

							
Serene ⊗ High	Energy High	Uplift High	Passion High	Power High	Hope High	Inspire High	Enrich High
							
Serene High	Energy ⊗ Medium	Uplift Medium	Passion Medium	Power High	Hope High	Inspire High	Enrich High
							
Serene High	Energy Medium	Uplift ⊗ Medium	Passion Medium	Power Medium	Hope High	Inspire High	Enrich High
							
Serene High	Energy High	Uplift Medium	Passion ⊗ Low	Power Low	Hope Medium	Inspire High	Enrich High

Contrast variations continued

The following pages show the recommended high-, medium- and low-contrast colour variations for RGB (digital) applications, as the document is set in RGB.

RGB applications include examples such as emailers, digital banners, social media posts, videos, etc.

CMYK applications include examples such as posters, billboards, pamphlets, brochures, business cards, etc.

⊗ Please avoid using the same colour text as the background.



Serene High	Energy High	Uplift High	Passion Low	Power ⊗	Hope Low	Inspire High	Enrich High
----------------	----------------	----------------	----------------	------------	-------------	-----------------	----------------



Serene High	Energy High	Uplift High	Passion Medium	Power Low	Hope ⊗	Inspire Low	Enrich High
----------------	----------------	----------------	-------------------	--------------	-----------	----------------	----------------



Serene High	Energy High	Uplift High	Passion High	Power Medium	Hope Low	Inspire ⊗	Enrich High
----------------	----------------	----------------	-----------------	-----------------	-------------	--------------	----------------



Serene High	Energy High	Uplift High	Passion High	Power Medium	Hope Medium	Inspire Low	Enrich ⊗
----------------	----------------	----------------	-----------------	-----------------	----------------	----------------	-------------

Contrast examples

These colour combinations provide a range of options on how to apply contrast in type. Choose what works best for the layout but, generally speaking, low-contrast tones in layouts are a great way to add a little more sophistication, while high-contrast tones usually work well where information needs to be conveyed boldly and clearly.

High



Passion on Serene



Inspire on Energy



Serene on Hope



Passion on Enrich

Medium



Power on Inspire



Uplift on Energy



Hope on Passion



Passion on Uplift

Low



Power on Passion



Hope on Power



Inspire on Hope



Hope on Inspire

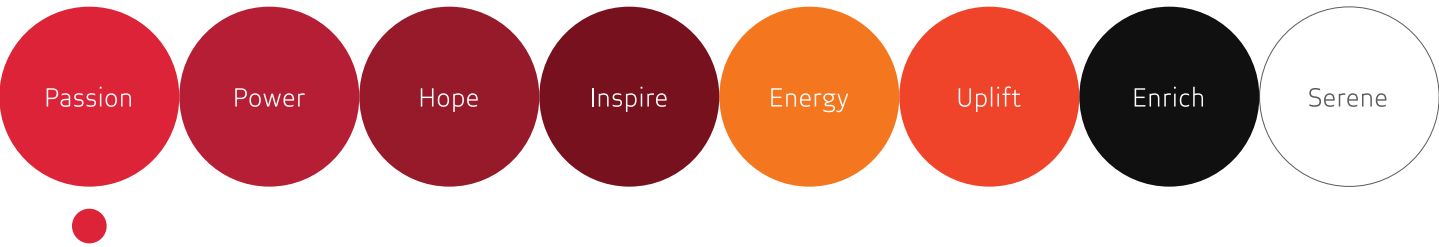
Colour in action

Red is dynamic, powerful and has a sense of movement. In this section, we've compiled various brand assets to showcase how our colour palette should be applied to add value, differentiate elements and bring our purpose to life.

Imagery

Imagery

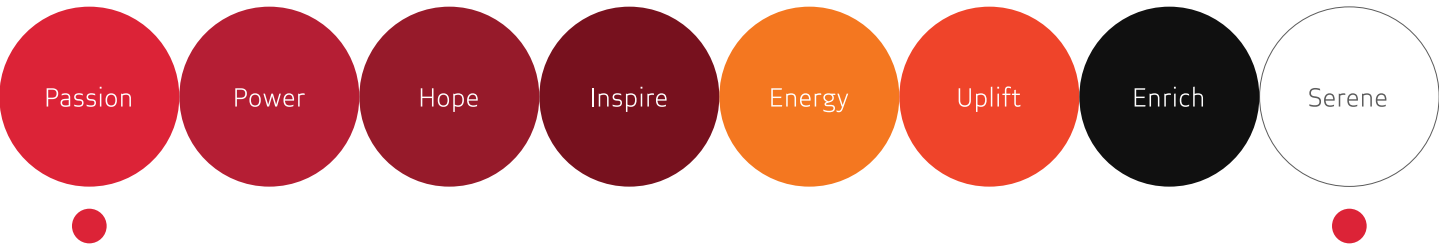
Take note of the Absa colours found in these images, not all eight colours need to be present in one image. Avoid using competitor bank colours and ensure that the photography treatment includes a pop of red.



Layouts

Layouts

When employing full-colour photography devoid of red tones, opt for the Passion red gestures to enhance visual harmony.





Derunt aut es ut aut lor
explac cum velicim dolore

absa.africa/signposting

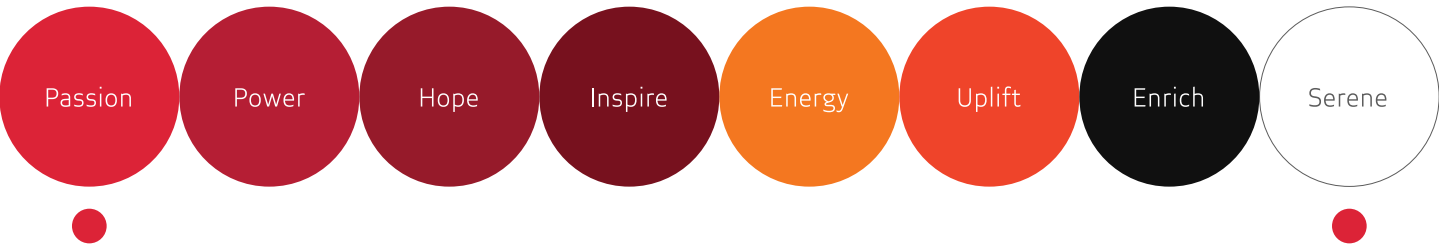
Your story matters



Terms and conditions apply
Legal fine

Layouts

If there is prominent white in the image, opt for red gestures.



Brand assets – colour

**We're for the
stories that are
just beginning**

absa.africa

Your story matters

absa

Authorised Financial Services Provider Registered Credit Provider Reg No NCRCP7

Layouts

A striking red overlay on Everyday Banking elements makes us distinctive and unmistakably red.

How to build your layouts using layers

For all layout formats.

Please note that templates may be requested from Avatar Agency. Follow instructions as per the images below, to get the best result.



When opening the template - make the layers visible. The layers will look as follows. All layers will be locked.

Layer 8: Margins and guides

Layer 7: Logo size and placement

Layer 6: Copy zone

Layer 5: Deep-etched image and gestures

Layer 4: Red overlay device - 100% opacity image pasted inside from the shape of the gestures

Layer 2 & 3: Overlaid red layers

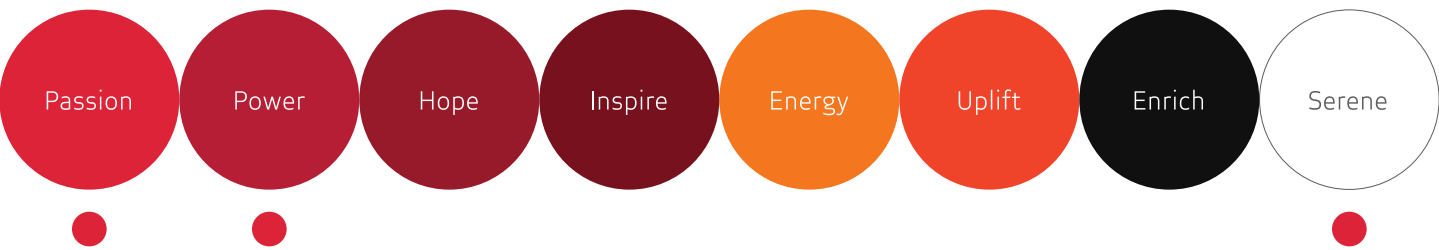
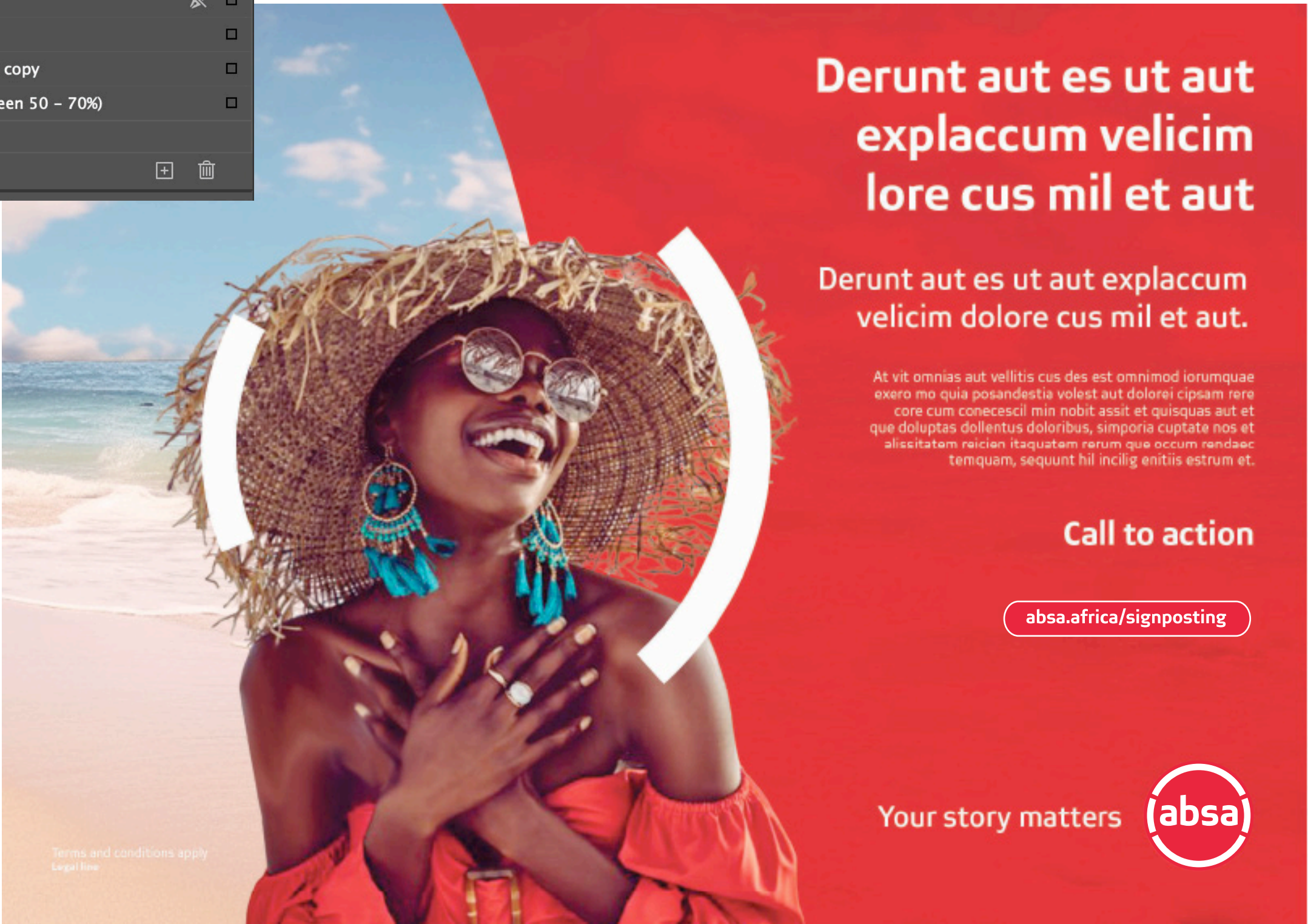
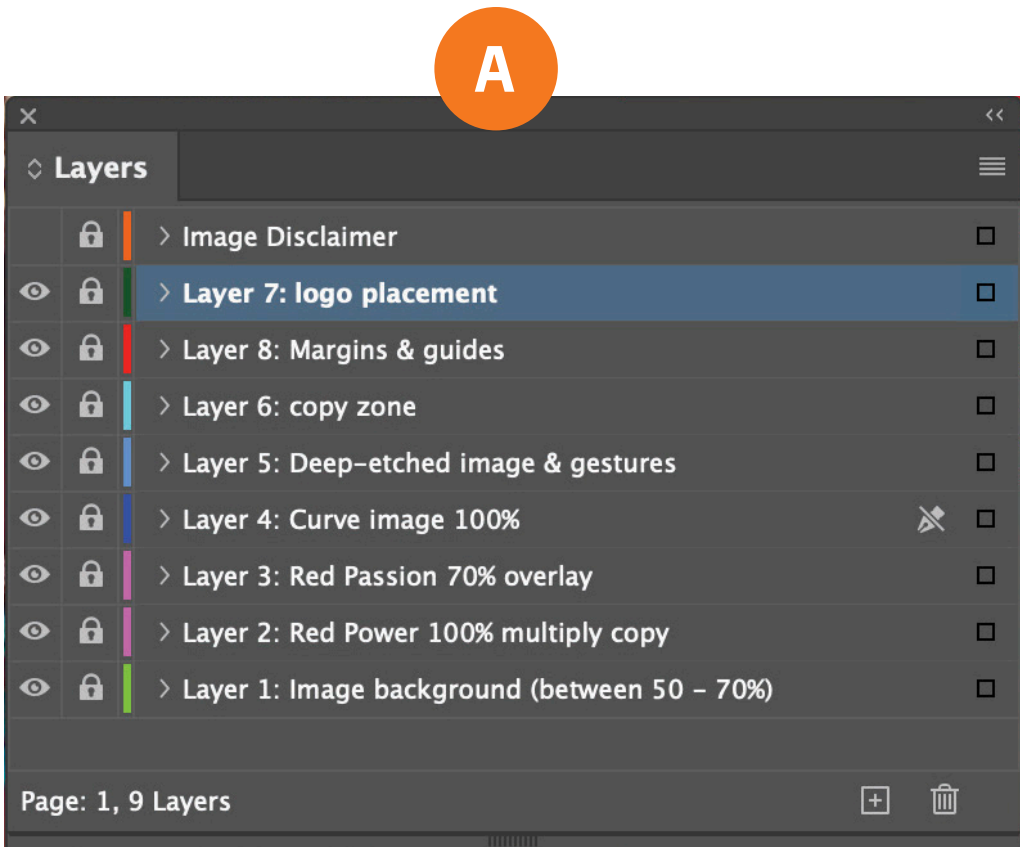
Layer 3: Passion red 70% overlay

Filll the layer with Power red 100% opacity
Effects | Transparency | Multiplied

Layer 2: Power red 100% multiply

This layer sits on top of the 2nd layer that is filled with Power red. Fill with Passion red 70% opacity - Effects | Transparency | Overlay.

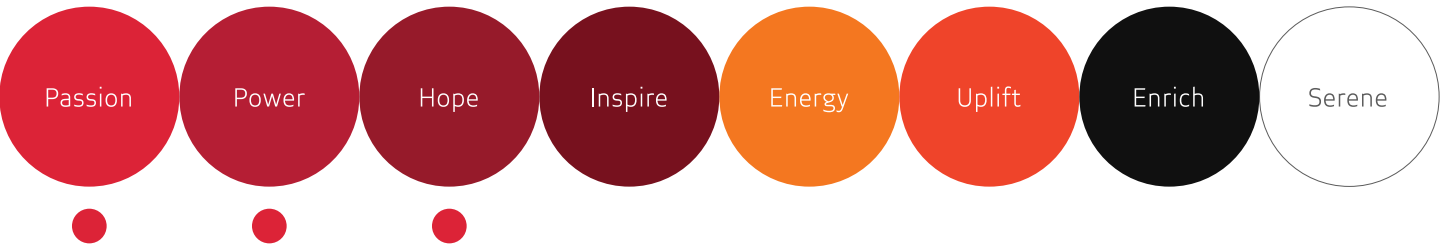
Layer 1: Background image (between 50-70% opacity)



Gestures patterns

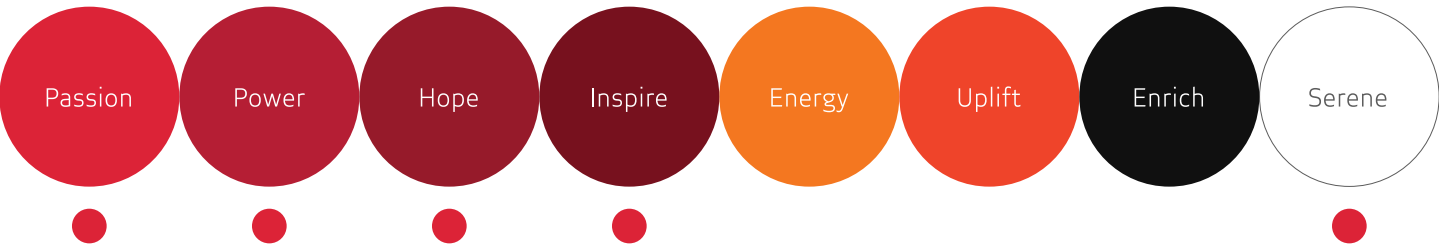
Gestures patterns – apparel

Gestures patterns can be created using the gestures device and applied on predominantly red apparel and accessories. Apparel should aim to be low and medium contrasts.



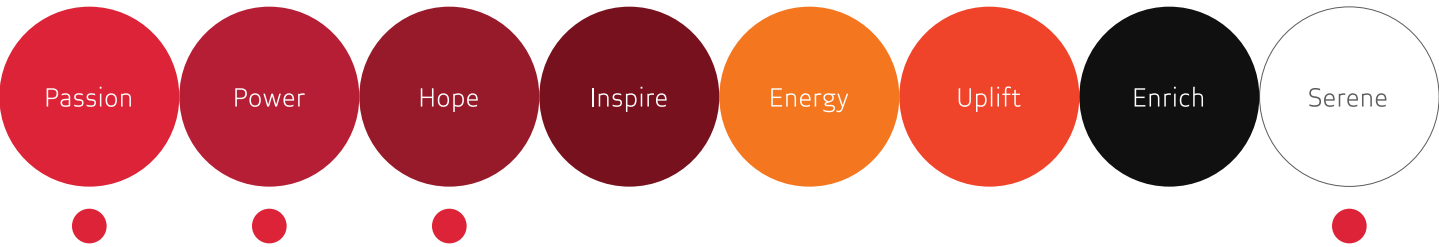
Gestures patterns – promotional items

Gestures patterns can be created using the gestures device and applied on predominantly red apparel and accessories. For promotional items, the colour contrast can be low, medium or high.



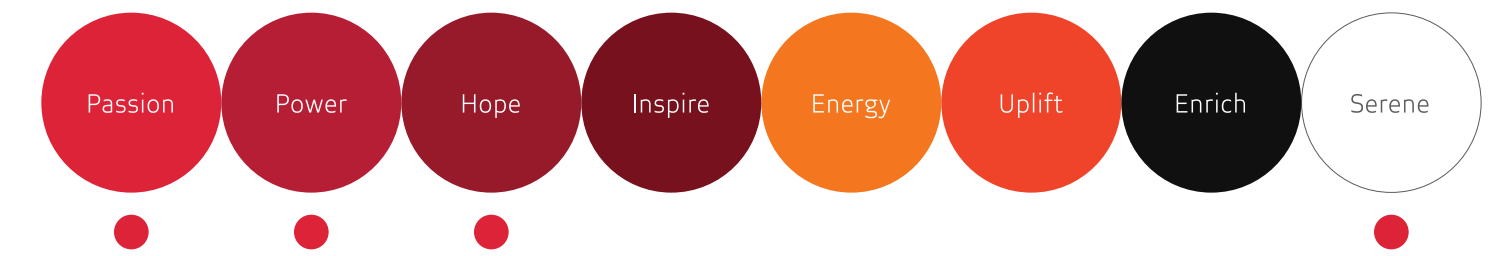
Gesture patterns – promotional items

Gestures patterns can be created using the gestures device and applied on predominantly red apparel and accessories. For promotional items, the colour contrast can be low, medium or high.



Gestures patterns – marketing collateral

Gestures patterns can be created using the gestures device and applied on predominantly red apparel and accessories. For marketing collateral, the colour contrast can be low, medium or high. A gradient may be used with the gestures instead of a flat background colour.



Dear [name and surname]

Body copy - Full width - 14px Regular. Itatur as et ad et di ut exerfer
epudige nihilit od que nus vendiassequi ut acculla di ut eos volecum ipiende
lestiss equibus, iduntis ut que sequodis qui dis et omnit, omnimet, cus.

Adis maior solores maio quae ipient eversperis atur apelend ucimi, a invent
volorae litemporit, sam, ut venihicto inulluptum et quunt.

Subheading - 18pt

Body copy - Full width - 14px Regular. Itatur as et ad et di ut exerfer epu-
dige nihilit od que nus vendiassequi ut acculla equibus, iduntis ut que
sequodis qui dis et omnit a invent volorae litemporit quunt.

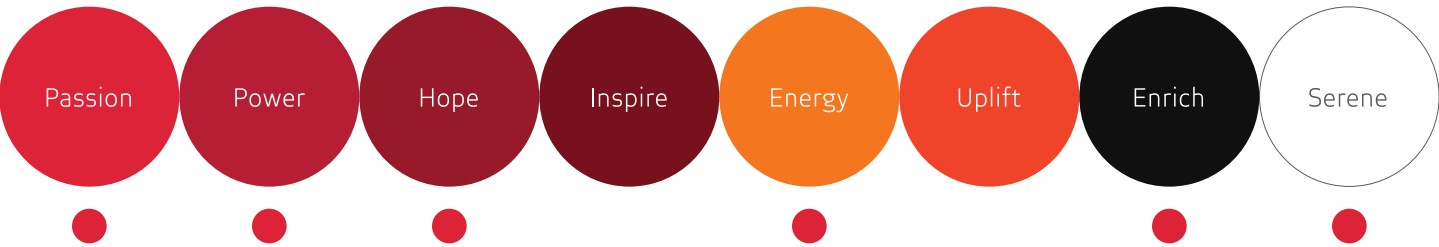
Call-out box - 2:1 column layout.
Header size 16px Bold

1. Od que nus vendiassequi ut acculla di ut.
2. Eos volecum ipiende lestiss equibus, iduntis que.
3. Sequodis qui dis et omnit, omnimet maio at cus.
4. Maior solores maio quae ipient litemporit.
5. Venihicto inulluptum et quunt.
6. Omnimet maio at cus.

Illustrations

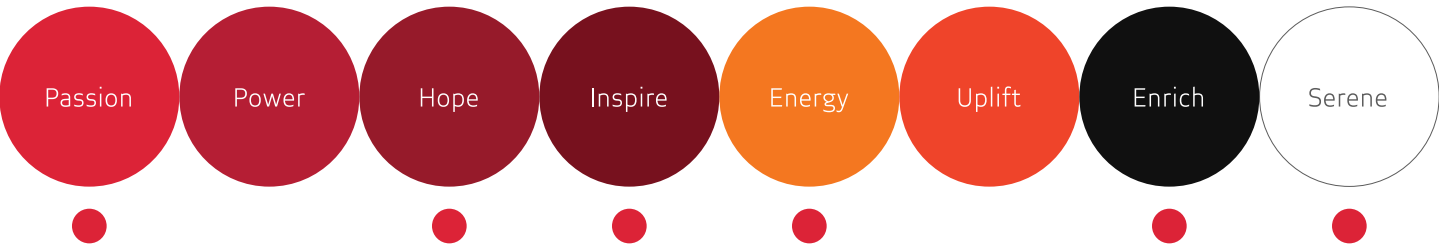
Illustrations

Our Absa illustrations use our full colour palette along with skin tones and neutrals to paint warm scenes. When mixing our colour palette, illustrations can lead with red but neutrals can also be included for a more balanced layout. This allows for variation in our illustration style.



Illustrations

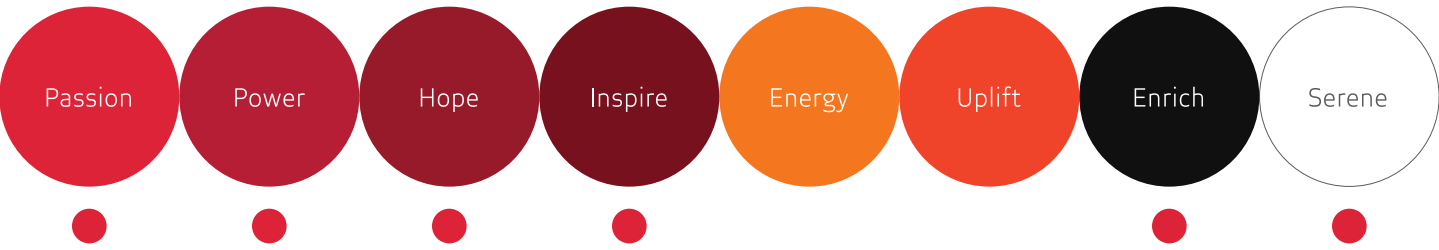
By including neutral tones alongside our full colour palette, we can paint warm scenes that are perfectly balanced.



Use colour to create a focal point that draws attention.

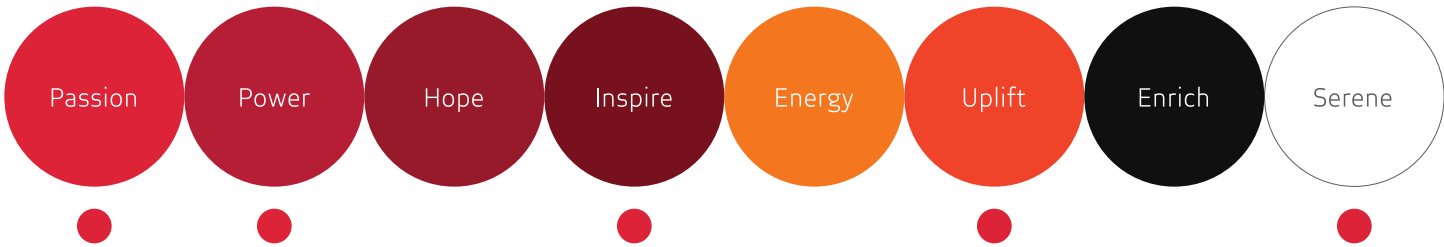
Illustrations

Accent colours like white can be incorporated into illustrations to create a focal point or to draw attention to certain elements or information.



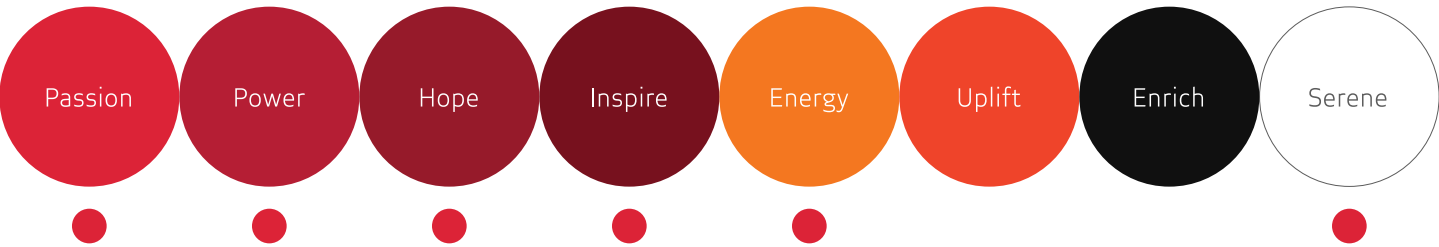
Illustrations

While our illustrations should appear predominantly red, the secondary reds and accent colours can be used to create depth and differentiation in the scene.



Illustrations

Secondary and accent colours can create a contrast with our primary red colour to tell a more accurate story.



The colour of our continent

Our red colour palette was inspired by the colours of Africa.



Iconography

Iconography

Our Absa icons serve two purposes: informative designs that could include high-contrast colours to enhance legibility and aesthetic designs that are best achieved using low- or medium-contrast colours and sometimes high-contrast colours.

Methods of payment

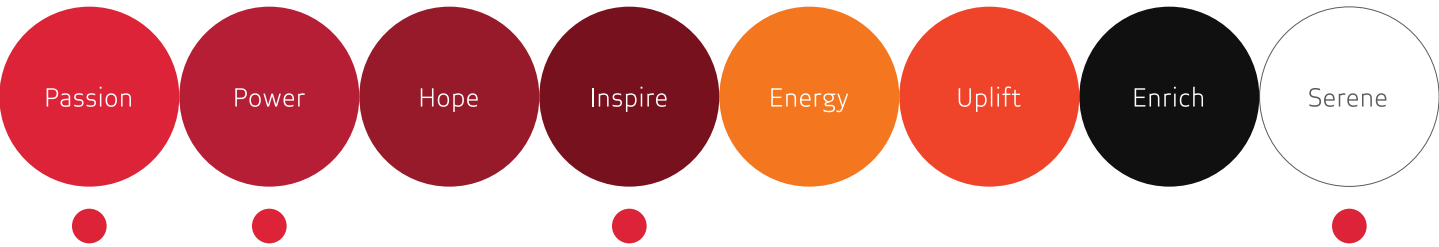
-  In any Absa branch
-  Online at absa.co.za/banking
-  With the Absa Banking App

Your story matters 



 **Forex**
 **with feeling**

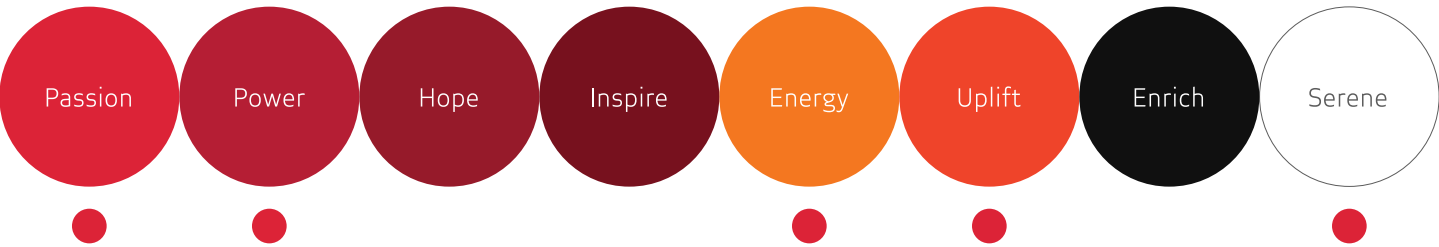
Your story matters 



Bespoke patterns

Bespoke patterns – high contrast

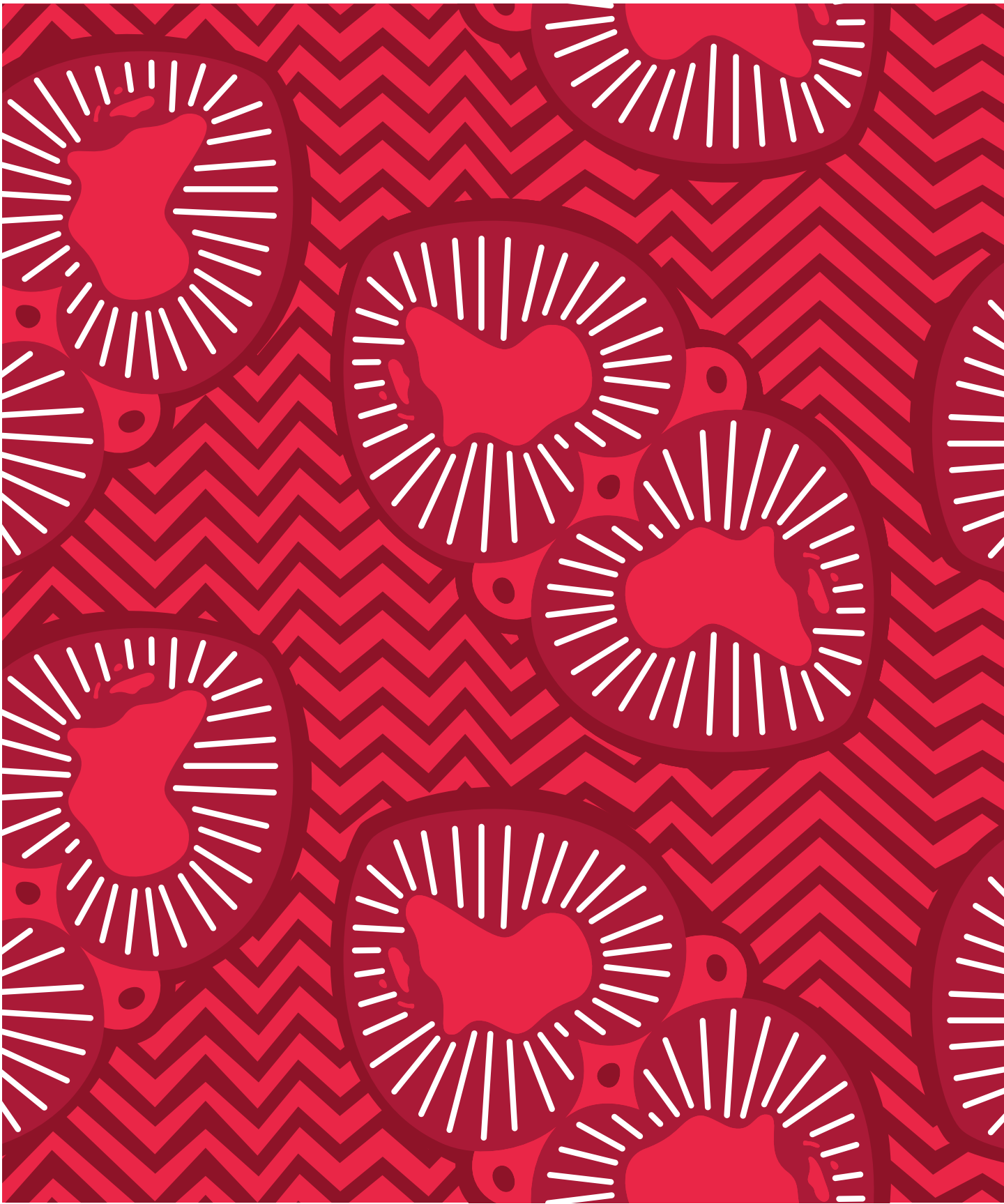
Absa is a bank with a Pan-African heritage, proudly African but distinctly Absa. Therefore, our patterns include African-inspired designs infused with our red colour palette. Bespoke patterns with high contrast work well to bring dynamism to event collateral or promotional items.



Brand assets – colour



Corporate reporting pattern



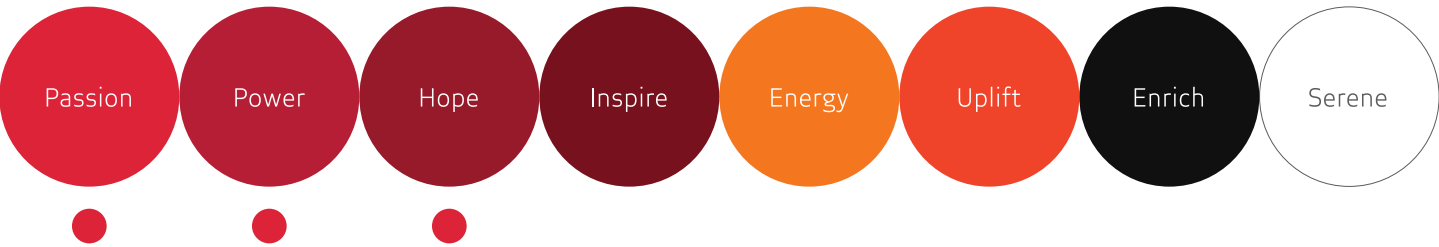
Kitenge African heartbeat



Shweshwe African heartbeat

Bespoke patterns – low contrast

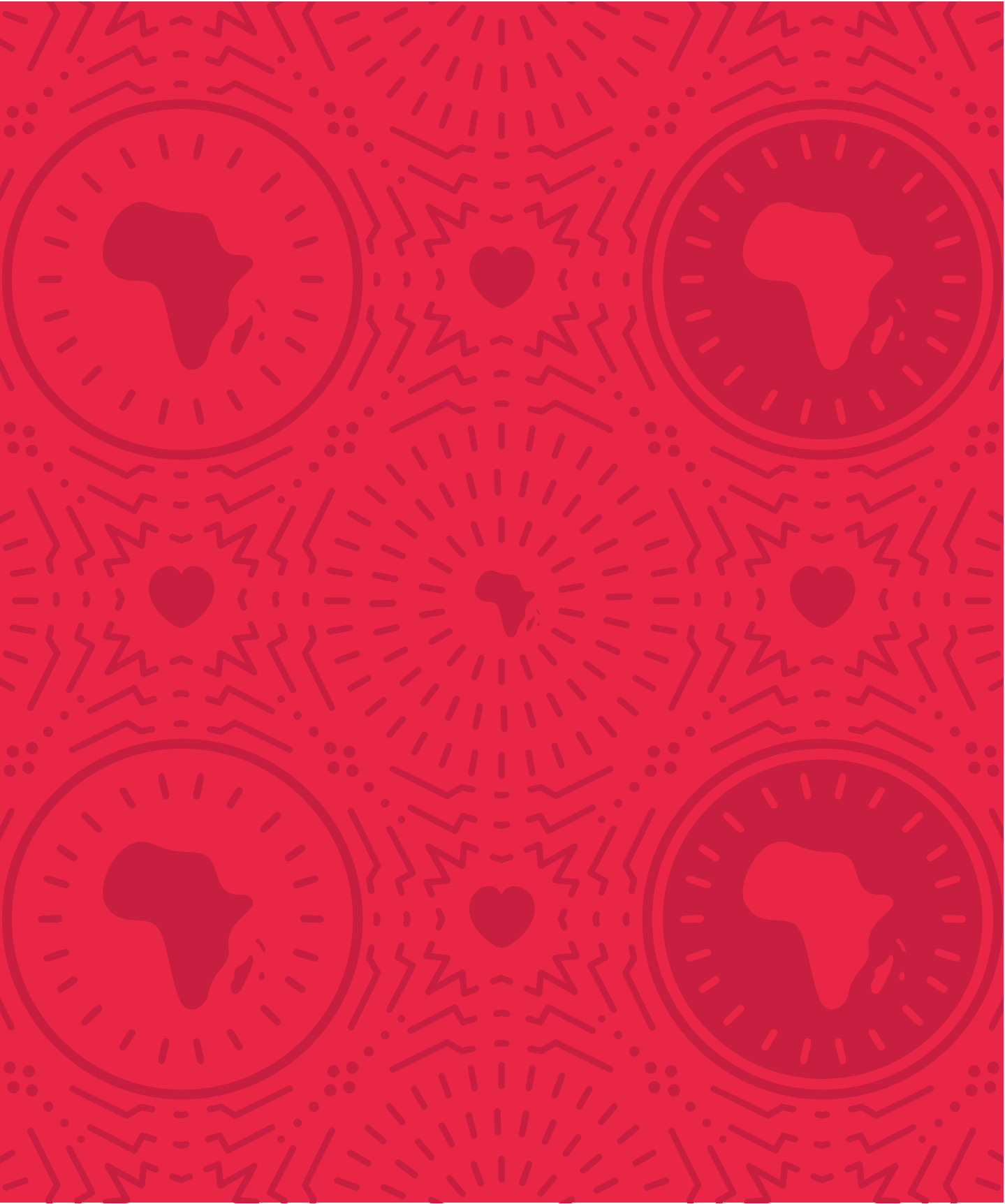
These bespoke patterns inspired by Africa have been created using Absa’s colour palette in low-contrast colours, making them more suitable for backgrounds in marketing and comms material.



Corporate reporting pattern



Kitenge African heartbeat



Shweshwe African heartbeat

The colour checklist

Your story matters



Our organisational purpose is “Empowering Africa’s tomorrow, together ... one story at a time”

As a brand, it is important for us to deliver value to you, meet your needs and make your life easier. We developed this checklist as a quick and easy way for you to check whether you applied the most important principles found in the this guide correctly. Always use this checklist before flighting your marketing, communications and other creative collateral.

Always use this checklist when reviewing the use of colour.

Specifications

- ☐ Are the colours from the Absa colour palette? No custom colours can be used. [See p5](#)
- ☐ Has the correct colour space been used for the medium? Physical applications must be either CMYK or Pantone, digital applications must be either RGB or HEX. [See p7](#)
- ☐ Have the colours been made up using the correct values? See colour swatches under Downloadable assets on the Absa Brand Management Platform. [See p6-7](#)

Application

- ☐ Do the colours in the visual work together to convey a feeling of red with a touch of accent? This applies to layouts and graphics (illustrations and bespoke patterns). [See p35-49](#)
- ☐ Do the chosen colour combinations align with the application ratio principle? Always remember that we need to balance the chosen colours to ensure that we show up as a red brand, as opposed to not being red enough. [See p12](#)
- ☐ Use application categories when unsure about which colours to use on which applications. [See p23](#)

Gradients

- ☐ Does the applied gradient consist predominantly of red? No gradient should exclude the use of Passion. [See p14-17](#)
- ☐ Does the applied tricolour gradient move from light to dark? Avoid jumping between light and dark colours, rather allow colours to gradually flow from a light to dark spectrum. [See p17](#)
- ☐ Are you using the appropriate gradient for your application? Gradients using Energy and Uplift will result in a more vibrant look, whereas gradients using Enrich and Inspire will result in a more sophisticated look. [See p15](#)
- ☐ Check that gradients are only applied to backgrounds. [See p14](#)

Contrast

- ☐ Are the colours appropriately contrasted for the message and the medium/application? [See p16](#)

Colour approval for physical applications

- ☐ Have you used accurate colour proofs to check colour before full production of physical items?

Contact information

For further information, please reach out to **BrandHelp@absa.africa**



Thank you